

Everything that i wanted to know
about bad breath but were afraid to
ask alfred hitchcock part III

Vaishali Narkar and Sanjeev Khandekar

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Everything You Wanted to Know About (Your) Bad Breath, but Were Afraid of Alfred Hitchcock is a series... III

Everything You Wanted to Know About (Your) Bad Breath, but Were Afraid to Ask Alfred Hitchcock is an ongoing, multi-part series by Sanjeev and Vaishali, first initiated in 2007. Comprising paintings, photographs, sculptures, and installations, the series has unfolded over time through exhibitions at Bombay Art Gallery (2008), Matthieu Foss Gallery (2010), and most recently, its third instalment presented in part by Sakshi Gallery at the India Art Fair, Delhi.

At its core, the project is a sharp critique of late capitalist excess and ecological collapse. The artists draw from thinkers such as Jason W. Moore—who argues that we are living through a planetary shift that could irreversibly alter Earth—and frame their own concerns around what Justin McBrien calls the Necrocene: an epoch where capitalism itself becomes an extinction event. For Sanjeev and Vaishali, the Necrocene marks not only environmental degradation but also the systematic erasure of species, cultures, and entire ways of life in the name of profit and growth.

Part 3 of the series specifically attempted to confront this existential transition, using symbolic and material metaphors to depict the violence of global capital. One recurring motif throughout the work is the refrigerator—not as a mundane household object, but as a chilling symbol of nature artificially frozen, controlled, and ultimately destroyed in the pursuit of comfort and consumption. In their 2020 sculpture *Freezed*, a monumental refrigerator door becomes an emblem of this dynamic: it cools the interior by consuming natural energy, while simultaneously heating the external world—a quiet allegory for the tragedy of the commons.

These sculptural refrigerator doors are adorned with striking imagery that exposes the brutalities of neoliberal development: one features impressions of endangered *Rhizophora* mangroves, another is built from coral and includes a hyperrealist painting of a skeletal farmer and his cow seeking grass during a drought. A third frames a haunting image—bleeding feet of a woman farmer who has marched hundreds of kilometres to Mumbai, protesting alongside thousands against agrarian distress.

Through this series, Sanjeev and Vaishali construct a powerful visual discourse that fuses the aesthetics of contemporary art with urgent planetary anxieties. The works compel us to reflect not just on the mechanisms of destruction, but on our own complicity in a world being transformed—silently and violently—by systems that reward accumulation over life itself.



Title: Everything you wanted to know about bad breath, but were afraid to ask Alfred Hitchcock
Part II: "freezed-3"
Medium: Fibre, glass, light
Size: 65 x 21.5 inches
Year: 2019